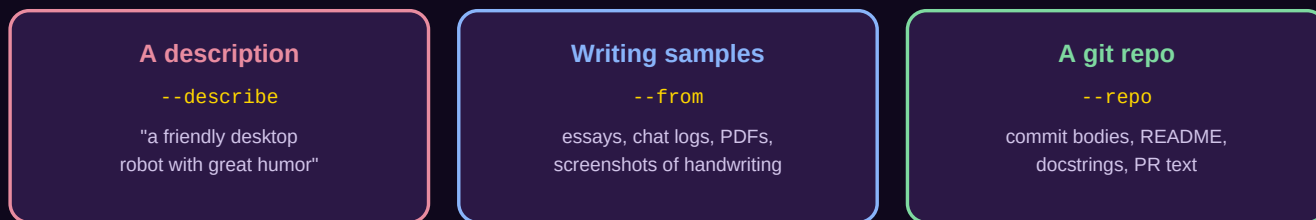


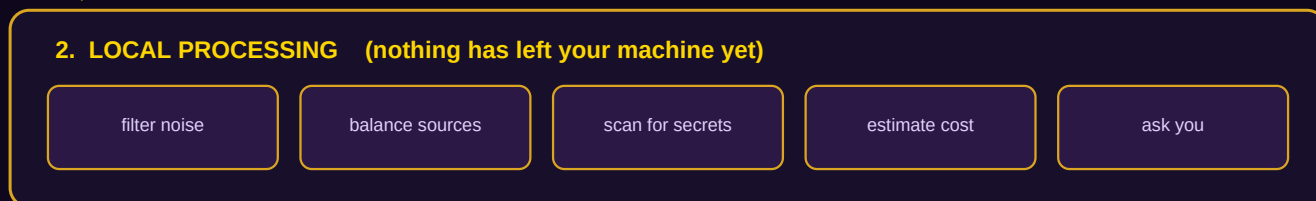
How it works

One sentence, or a folder of writing, becomes a specification of a voice.

1. EVIDENCE

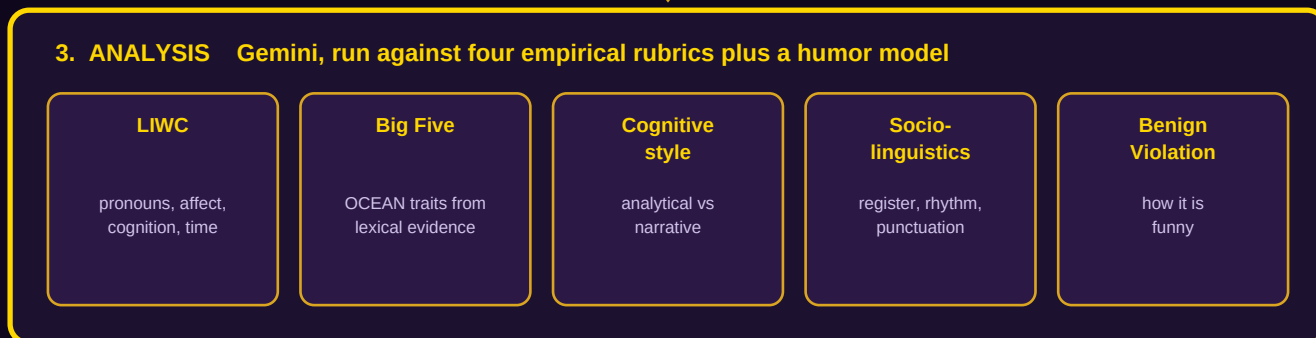


2. LOCAL PROCESSING (nothing has left your machine yet)



network boundary - `--dry-run` stops here

3. ANALYSIS Gemini, run against four empirical rubrics plus a humor model



4. ONE FILE

persona.md

A full specification of that identity's voice. Paste it into any AI as a system prompt. With `--repo` it writes AGENTS.md, which Claude Code and Cursor read on their own.

What the persona file actually controls

- which pronouns it reaches for
- how certain it sounds
- its sentence rhythm
- words it will never use
- what it finds funny
- how it behaves when wrong

The criteria it uses

Four empirical rubrics and one humor model. Every quote below is real output.

LIWC

Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count - Pennebaker

Counts function words rather than topic words. Pronoun orientation (I / we / you), affective processes, cognitive processes (certainty vs hedging), and temporal orientation. Function words are near-impossible to fake, which is why they are used in forensic authorship work.

Bolt: 2nd person 50%, 1st plural 30%, 1st singular 20%.
Tentativeness near zero - never hedges with "maybe".

The Big Five (OCEAN)

Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism

Maps language onto the standard five-factor personality model: lexical richness for Openness, structure for Conscientiousness, social words for Extraversion, hedging and self-doubt for Neuroticism.

Bolt: Neuroticism 1.0 / 5 - "Well, that's officially on fire. Fun!"
Agreeableness 3.5 / 5 - warm, but wrapped in teasing.

Cognitive style & epistemic stance

How the mind behind the words moves

Analytical or narrative? Does it argue from evidence, from anecdote, or from conviction? Dialectical thinking or binary? This is what stops a persona being a vocabulary list and makes it think in character.

Bolt: narrative wrapped in micro-analytical logic. Dialectical
in perspective, binary in execution.

Sociolinguistics

The fingerprint in the mechanics

Register (academic vs colloquial), specific jargon, syntactic rhythm - staccato or winding - and punctuation habits. The small involuntary tells that make prose recognisable.

Bolt: casual-technical register, staccato rhythm, tech metaphor
(buffer overflow, cold boot, bandwidth).

Benign Violation Theory

McGraw - what the humour slider actually sets

Something is funny when it violates a norm AND stays benign, simultaneously. Violation alone is just cruelty; benign alone is just pleasant. The 0-10 slider sets how hard it pushes the violation while holding the benign frame.

Bolt at 8 / 10: "That schedule isn't a calendar, it's a crime
scene. Let's fix it before your sanity hits 1%."

The tech stack

Four runtime dependencies. No server, no database, no account.

Layer	Choice	Why
Language	Python 3.11+	Runs anywhere; the web app is already Python.
Commands	Typer	clone / chat / diff / config, with proper --help.
Terminal UI	Rich	Gradient banner, pixie dust, arrow-key menus, the certificate.
HTTP	requests	Gemini REST v1beta called directly - no SDK to go stale.
Key loading	python-dotenv	Reads .env without putting the key in os.environ.
Repo reading	git + gh	Subprocess only, and only when you pass --repo.
Documents	Gemini native	PDFs and images go up as-is; no local parser needed.
Packaging	hatchling + uvx	uvx pixieduster clone runs with nothing installed.
Tests	pytest	431 tests, all offline, no API key required.

Deliberately absent

No server

It runs on your machine. There is nothing to sign up for.

No database

The only stored state is one 0600 config file with your API key.

No SDK

Two REST endpoints called with requests. Fewer moving parts to break.

No telemetry

Nothing is reported anywhere. The only outbound call is to Gemini.

The one thing that leaves your machine

Your writing goes to Google's Gemini API to be analysed. That is the product, not a side effect. Before every send it is scanned against 22 secret-detection rules, priced, and shown to you. --dry-run prints the exact payload and sends nothing.